

Data Analyst Interview – Practical Questions

EXCEL – Important Practical Questions

1. VLOOKUP / XLOOKUP: Bring salary from Sheet2 into Sheet1 using Employee ID. Explain difference between VLOOKUP and XLOOKUP.
2. IF and Nested IF: Classify students based on marks (Distinction, First Class, Fail).
3. Pivot Table: Find total sales by region and top 5 products from sales data.
4. Conditional Formatting: Highlight sales greater than 50,000 and less than 10,000.
5. COUNTIF and SUMIF: Count employees from Sales department and calculate January sales.
6. Data Cleaning: Remove duplicates, handle blanks, and clean extra spaces using TRIM.

SQL – Important Practical Questions

1. SELECT with WHERE: Fetch employees with salary greater than 40,000.
2. GROUP BY with SUM: Find total sales for each product.
3. ORDER BY and LIMIT: Find top 5 highest paid employees.
4. JOINS: Join Employee and Department tables. Explain INNER JOIN vs LEFT JOIN.
5. COUNT vs COUNT(*): Explain the difference.
6. Subquery: Find employees earning more than the average salary.

Power BI – Important Practical Questions

1. What is Power BI and why is it used in Data Analytics?
2. Power BI Workflow: Explain steps from data source to dashboard.
3. Power Query: Explain data cleaning and transformation steps.
4. DAX: Difference between calculated column and measure.
5. Relationships: Explain one-to-many relationship and its importance.
6. Slicers and Filters: How slicers help in dashboard analysis.